

Roman Key Card Blackwood - 1430 version

RKCB is similar to Blackwood, but instead of four Aces there are Five Keycards. They are the Aces plus the King of the agreed trump suit. Starting with 4NT, a reply of 5♣ shows 1 or 4 Keycards, 5♦ shows 0 or 3, 5♥ shows 2 Keycards but no trump Queen, and 5♠ shows 2 Keycards with the trump Queen.

If your side has all five Keycards, bidding 5NT will repeat the process for Kings, remembering that there are only three Kings since the trump King is counted as a Keycard. There are two popular methods for responding to 5NT. The first is the same as normal Blackwood - 6♣ shows no Kings, 6♦ shows one, and 6♥ shows three. This is the method used in the recommended bidding here.

If the response to 4NT is 5♣ or 5♦ the 4NT bidder may choose to ask about the trump Queen rather than ask for Kings. She does this by bidding the cheapest non-trump suit. Partner denies the trump Queen by returning to the trump suit. A 5NT bid confirms the trump Queen, but shows no outside Kings. Bidding any non-trump suit confirms the trump Queen and also the King of the suit bid.

Void showing by Responder is handled just as in regular Blackwood except it refers to one or two Keycards, rather than one or two Aces.

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 6 ♠

Declarer: North

Lead: ♠ 9

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 6 ♥

Declarer: East

Lead: ♣ J

Board: 3

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 6 ♥

Declarer: South

Lead: ♣ J

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 6 ♥

Declarer: West

Lead: ♦ 4

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 7
 ♥ 10 6 3
 ♦ A 10 3 2
 ♣ J 10 7 3

♠ A Q J 8 6 2

♥ K Q 7

♦ K Q J

♣ A



♠ 9 4

♥ J 8 4

♦ 9 7 6

♣ K Q 9 8 2

♠ K 5 3

♥ A 9 5 2

♦ 8 5 4

♣ 6 5 4

NORTH realizes SOUTH has fewer than 8 points, but the 3♠ support bid is enough for her to try a RKCB 4NT bid.

SOUTH shows two Key Cards and NORTH figures they will be the ♠K and one of the red Aces. So she bids 6♠. If instead the Key Cards are the two red Aces NORTH might possibly make all thirteen tricks with a finesse.

West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♠	Pass	3♠
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♥
Pass	6♠		
All Pass			
6♠ by North			
Lead: ♠9			

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 7 2
 ♥ Q 7 4
 ♦ 9 8 5
 ♣ 9 8 4 3

♠ 9 8 4

♥ J 8

♦ K Q 10 7 4

♣ 7 6 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K Q J 5

♥ A K 6 5 2

♦ 6

♣ A K Q

♠ 10 6 3

♥ 10 9 3

♦ A J 3 2

♣ J 10 2

WEST's 3♥ bid is "encouraging" so EAST bids 4NT.

When WEST shows one Key Card, (an Ace), EAST is afraid he may have a trump loser as well the other Ace. To find out about the ♥Q he bids 5♦, the Queen Ask.

WEST has the ♥Q but no King so she jumps to 6♥.

West	North	East	South
		2♣	Pass
2♦	Pass	2♥	Pass
3♥	Pass	4NT	Pass
5♣	Pass	5♦	Pass
6♥			
All Pass			
6♥ by East			
Lead: ♣J			

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 8 3
 ♥ 10 3
 ♦ Q J 7 4
 ♣ J 10 7 6

♠ A 7 2

♥ J 9 8 7 4

♦ 8 5

♣ 8 4 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 10 6 4

♥ Q

♦ A K 10 9 3 2

♣ 9 5 2

♠ K Q J 5

♥ A K 6 5 2

♦ 6

♣ A K Q

This is the companion to Deal 22.

Again, worried about a possible trump loser in addition to the missing Ace, SOUTH bids 5♦, the Queen Ask.

NORTH definitely does NOT have the ♥Q. But with five trumps she does know that SOUTH probably does not have a trump loser so she jumps to 6♥ anyway.

West	North	East	South
			2♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	2♥
Pass	3♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♣	Pass	5♦
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			
6♥ by South			
Lead: ♣J			

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ 8 5
 ♥ K Q 9 6 4
 ♦ 7 3
 ♣ A K 8 5

♠ J 7 2

♥ 10 8

♦ J 9 8 6 4

♣ 10 7 3



♠ A K 9 6 3

♥ A J 7 5

♦ K Q 2

♣ 6

♠ Q 10 4

♥ 3 2

♦ A 10 5

♣ Q J 9 4 2

EAST cannot use RKCB at her second bid because trumps have not been agreed. So she bids 3♥ to set trumps, knowing WEST cannot pass after her jump-shift.

WEST tries to stop at game but EAST is too strong so she now uses RKCB and gets to 6♥ when WEST shows two Key Cards and the trump Queen.

West	North	East	South
1♥	Pass	2♠	Pass
3♣	Pass	3♥	Pass
4♥	Pass	4NT	Pass
5♠	Pass	6♥	
All Pass			
6♥ by West			
Lead: ♦ 4			